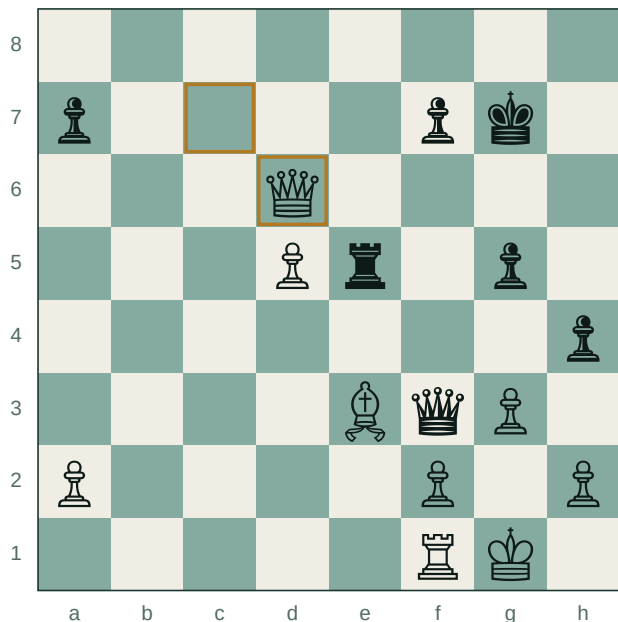


# Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 27

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Qxd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**27...h3 28. Qxe5+ Kh7 29. Qf5+ Qxf5**

**27...h3** The pawn moves from h4 to h3. Recorded reply: **28.Qxe5+**.

**28...Kh7** The king moves from g7 to h7. Recorded reply: **29.Qf5+**.

**29...Qxf5** The queen captures the queen on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d6. Check for tactical protection.